

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Barb Dwyer

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years in the CIA investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control.

- Coordinates museum security with **Artie Ficial** and **Chip Patina**.
- **Paige Turner** keeps requesting access Barb has already refused.
- Makes **Brie DeVivre** revise the service routes. **Brie** would like one final version.

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Barb Dwyer. I am security. Please behave as though I have already noticed whatever you are about to try.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Barb Dwyer

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant ordered you to disable the Donor Salon camera because he planned several off-the-record meetings. He then told you that if anything went wrong tonight, security would 'own the failure.'

Your other secret

You personally unplugged the camera despite museum policy. The work order records the disconnection, but you never documented Grant's threat to make security take the blame.

Conversations to start

- Find out who knew the Donor Salon camera was offline.
- Ask Artie Ficial why Grant wanted the Donor Salon camera switched off. Keep your own part in that decision private for now.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1** *The red curtains conceal more than the view beyond the window.*
- 2** *An icy archive is preserving something other than supper.*
- 3** *A champion's keepsake is concealing something beneath its base.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I unplugged the salon camera. Grant signed the work order, then told me security would own any failure. I should have refused. Instead I preserved the order and let him have his private meetings. He wanted witnesses for his generosity and no witnesses for what he said beforehand.

IF MURDERER

Grant ordered the salon camera disconnected and threatened to blame me for anything that followed. I unplugged it myself. The order has his signature; my threat report is missing because I never wrote one. He understood the difference between an instruction he could prove and a conversation I could not.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

From 6:39 to 6:45 I staffed the north checkpoint, replacing sixteen misprinted badges. That camera stayed on. You can count every badge and every trip I did not make. Grant's private salon was across the building. Turning off one camera did not turn off the museum.

IF MURDERER

I dealt with the badge problem at the north door, then left the replacement stack with an attendant. Around 6:42 I checked the salon corridor. The disabled camera was still disconnected, exactly as ordered. I returned toward the gallery before the toast. Grant had asked for privacy, and the museum was providing it.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Barb Dwyer

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Barb Dwyer

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

My access key opened the preparation cabinet as well as the camera cupboard. I collected linen to cover the lens while disconnecting it. I kept Grant's signed order under the badge tray. That was self-protection. My mistake was obeying him; somebody else benefited from it.

IF MURDERER

I had the preparation key and museum linen while disabling the camera. The signed order was under the badge tray. I checked the salon corridor without making a second work entry; it was already part of the shutdown. Grant's insistence on an unrecorded room made the investigation considerably harder.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Barb Dwyer

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Barb Dwyer

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I made the salon blind and failed to document the threat. The separate north checkpoint recording keeps me at the badge station throughout the contamination interval. Sixteen bad badges are a better alibi than my professional pride. I helped create the opportunity. I did not use it to kill him.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I knew which camera was dead because I disconnected it. I took the reference sample through the preparation cabinet and wiped Grant's coupe while pretending to inspect the corridor. The badge stack continued without me. He intended to make security own a failure; this one is mine, although he never lived to make the accusation.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.
